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James Rocco Project '25
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Report: Week 1

Week 1-2 goals (per proposal):

- Data cleaning and organization for closed institutions
- Imputations
- Statistical analyses of data
- Literature review

Accomplishments

Literature Review:

[in order of completion]

- Started with literature review, browsing through existing literature on higher education institutions closure, enrollment data, its trends and effects, along with any other topic, relevant or related to the project.
- Gathered literature reviewed in a structured and organized bibliography file for easy reference, along with a small summary / note for each source, to minimize redundant reading.
- Met with project advisor to discuss the literature review, get feedback on the direction of the reviews, and identify further areas to explore. Noted down additional sources to review in the following and last week of the lit review.

Data Cleaning:

[in order of completion]

- Reviewed the data provided by the project advisor, to get a clear understanding of the data structure, variables, and potential issues.
- Explored data sources, outlined in the proposal.
- Noted potential issues and considerations for data, and discussed with the project advisor. Next steps were identified which I'll be working on in the following week. My goal is to have two cleaned and organized datasets by the beginning of Week 3. However, the process of collecting and cleaning additional supporting data may not be completed by even the last weeks of the project.

Learning:

Due to my very basic knowledge of Bayesian Hierarchical models, I'm aiming to spend some time in Week 1-2 learning, so I can be more efficient in Week 3-6 when I start trying to implement different models and running inferences. This is of course not part of the original proposal, but somewhat necessary to achieve high quality results.